

Dynamic contrast ratio

This much-hyped term is maligned in our labs and for good reason – it takes into account backlight adjustment and variable brightness

Torchlight makes it big

The dungeon crawler Torchlight has just sold 5,00,000 copies. The publisher buys a stake in the developer studios for 8.4 million US dollars

The twin lights on the sides of the TV are a distraction when watching anything, unless you're gaming, in which case you're close enough to the display to ignore them. LG's menu system is very good – brilliant in fact – simple, yet detailed and requires less button presses than Sony's menu.

The colour produced is really nice – the 42LH6OYR is as good as the 47LH5OYR in this regard. Colours have a natural and very realistic tone. The contrast, typical for an IPS panel wasn't up to the mark and is this display's only weakness. The blackness level wasn't up to the 47-inch LG 47LH5OYR and this becomes noticeable when watching movies with a lot of dim scenes. Still, it's not a major deterrent in regular viewing, unless you're really discerning.

When calibrating the Jazz Theatre, we found we could get a better black level, but at the expense of the picture becoming relatively dimmer than what is acceptable for viewing purposes. When kept at good brightness levels, the blackness level is mediocre. Regardless, at normal brightness and contrast levels, blacks appear washed out – not a very good thing. When gaming, what was very nice was the nearly total absence of input lag. That, combined with some great colour and adequate contrast, made for a highly satisfying gaming experience. The speakers do their job nicely, although they're not very different from the 47LH5OYR's speakers – which is a compliment to the larger sibling.

An MRP of Rs. 70,900 might seem a lot for a 42-inch display these days, but with LG street prices should be much lower – close to Rs. 60,000 – this makes it a good buy, although you could just as easily go with the 42-inch version of the LH50 series and not miss anything.

Moser Baer MBIK32HD

Highly affordable surprise package

MoserBaer isn't a huge name in HDTV circles, but their MBIK32HD impressed us with good build quality that was much better than the Onida 32-inch Diamond Kyrock. Even the stand is more rigid – something the Onida sorely lacked. Bright reds have a distinctly pink hue. This is immediately noticeable, and quite annoying. Manually tuning the display mitigates this to some extent. Note that this is not a full-HD display – 1366 x 768 is the native resolution. The remote unit is decent, mediocre build quality but buttons work well and are well spaced, it also works well from close to the display. DivX through USB is supported.

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JUNE 2010



Moser Baer MBIK32HD

Post calibration, we noticed finer texture on the skin. The contrast is much better than the Onida Diamond Kyrock, which one would normally pit against this display, both being in the same size class. Pixel sharpness is good, and even though this isn't a full HD screen you will not notice any problem viewing 1080p videos. Good greys and blacks along with a good contrast ratio mean a better all round experience. There is very good highlighting in movies – sun on a person's face, sweat beads etc. The colours are vibrant, but not over rich. The slight lack of tonal accuracy and neutrality spoils things, especially in scenes with a lot of red, where pinkish hue is noticeable.

Gaming is fun – a lack of input lag makes first person games easy to play because aiming is mostly spot on. Surprisingly, highlighting is not as good in games – but this is probably because of the lower native resolution that it is not as noticeable. The obvious solution would be to move farther away from a lower resolution display, to make up for the pixel count, but this intrudes on the immersive feeling of being closer to the view.

Overall, the MBIK32HD impressed us with a very good picture quality and will definitely satisfy someone looking for an affordable display with good performance to boot. A retail price of Rs. 29,990 is pretty low, even for 32-inch displays – if the market price is any

lower, the MBIK32HD is a steal of a deal, although, we haven't come across many MoserBaer displays in electronic malls. It's a brilliant value buy – our Best Buy, an award shared with the Haier LB32R3.

Onida 32 Diamond Kyrock

Doesn't rock hard enough!

The Diamond Kyrock underwhelmed us from the beginning. To start with, its build quality is iffy – while the panel is encased in thick plastic, the stand has a fair bit of play and the TV can actually vibrate on account of this, if you touch it. The stand is one of the most important parts of the body of a TV, especially since



Onida 32 Diamond Kyrock

many people are averse to wall mounting smaller displays, and having a wobbly stand is a glaring minus. The menu buttons are on the top of the TV – this makes them easy to use if the TV is on a table, as long as it's not too high. But not so if it's wall mounted – all the more ammunition against Onida for the shaky stand. The remote has very nice, soft buttons that are a joy to use and although the menus are laid out well and are pretty simple, some advanced